Balsamic Vinaigrette

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🫗 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🍇 1/2 cup balsamic vinegar
- 🟡 2 tsp dijon mustard
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🧂 1 tsp salt
- 🌑 1/4 tsp black pepper

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, balsamic vinegar 🍇, dijon mustard 🟡, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, salt 🧂, and black pepper 🌑
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Caesar Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Prep: Mayonnaise

- 🥚 1 egg yolk
- 🪚 200ml sunflower oil
- 🍋 1 tsp lemon juice
- 🧂 Pinch of salt

1. Whisk the egg yolk 🥚 with lemon juice 🍋 and salt 🧂
2. Slowly drizzle in the oil 🪚 while whisking until emulsified

Ingredients

- 🥣 1 cup mayonnaise (from prep above)
- 🧀 1/2 cup parmigiano reggiano, grated
- 🟤 2 tsp Worcestershire sauce
- 🐟 4 anchovies
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves

Steps

1. Combine mayonnaise 🥣, parmigiano 🧀, Worcestershire sauce 🟤, anchovies 🐟, and garlic 🧄 in a food processor. Blend until smooth
2. Transfer to a container and refrigerate

Notes

Produces a thicker version of the classic dressing

All ingredients should be at room temperature for best results

For Caesar salad: toss with romaine lettuce and croutons, top with more parmigiano 🧀

Chili Lime Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🍈 2 limes, zest and juice
- 🍇 1/4 cup red wine vinegar
- 🍶 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🫒 1/3 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🌶️ 1/2 tsp red pepper flakes
- 🌱 1 tsp ground cumin
- 🧂 1/2 tsp salt

Steps

1. Whisk together lime zest and juice 🍈, red wine vinegar 🍇, soy sauce 🍶, honey 🍯, olive oil 🫒, garlic powder 🧄, red pepper flakes 🌶️, cumin 🌱, and salt 🧂
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Lemon Vinaigrette

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🫗 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🍇 1/2 cup balsamic vinegar
- 🟡 2 tsp dijon mustard
- 🍋 1 lemon, zest and juice
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🧂 1 tsp salt
- 🌑 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 🌿 2 tsp dried oregano

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, balsamic vinegar 🍇, dijon mustard 🟡, lemon zest and juice 🍋, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, salt 🧂, pepper 🌑, and oregano 🌿
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Mayonnaise

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🥚 1 large egg yolk
- 🟡 1 tbsp dijon mustard
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced
- 🫗 1 cup vegetable oil
- 🧂 Salt to taste
- 🌑 Black pepper to taste

Steps

1. Combine egg yolk 🥚, dijon mustard 🟡, and lemon juice 🍋 in a blender. Blend until mixed
2. With the blender on low, slowly drizzle in the oil 🫗 — go gradually to emulsify properly
3. Continue adding oil 🫗 until fully incorporated and thick
4. Season with salt 🧂 and pepper 🌑. Refrigerate

Notes

All ingredients should be at room temperature

If too thick, whisk in a teaspoon of water

Pesto

Servings: 4

Ingredients

🌿 2 cups fresh basil leaves, packed

🧀 1/2 cup grated parmesan

🌰 1/3 cup pine nuts

🧄 3 garlic cloves

🧂 1/4 tsp salt

🌑 1/8 tsp black pepper

🫒 1/2 cup extra virgin olive oil

Steps

1. Place basil 🌿, parmesan 🧀, pine nuts 🌰, garlic 🧄, salt 🧂, and pepper 🌑 in a food processor
2. Slowly drizzle in olive oil 🫒 while the processor is running
3. Pulse until smooth

Notes

Swap pine nuts 🌰 for walnuts, almonds, or sunflower seeds

Swap basil 🌿 for spinach, arugula, radish leaves, or kale

Stores in the fridge up to a week, freezes up to 3 months

Sesame Ginger Dressing

Servings: 1 cup

Ingredients

- 🫗 1/3 cup extra virgin olive oil
- 🏺 2 tbsp toasted sesame oil
- 🍶 1/4 cup rice vinegar + 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 🧄 1 tsp garlic powder
- 🍯 1 tbsp honey
- 🌱 2 tsp ground ginger

Steps

1. Whisk together olive oil 🫗, sesame oil 🏺, rice vinegar and soy sauce 🍶, garlic powder 🧄, honey 🍯, and ginger 🌱
2. Shake well before using if separated

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to 2 weeks

Use a squeeze bottle for easy dispensing

Baba Ganoush

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍆 2 medium eggplants
- 🥄 3 tbsp tahini
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🥣 1 tbsp Greek yoghurt
- 🧂 1/4 tsp salt
- 🌑 1/8 tsp pepper
- 🌿 1 tsp sumac
- 🫒 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🌶️ 1 tsp red pepper flakes (optional)

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 200°C. Poke the eggplants 🍆 with a fork, place on a baking sheet and roast 30–40 min until charred and soft
2. Let the eggplants 🍆 cool 15 min, then peel off and discard the skin
3. Place the eggplant 🍆 flesh in a food processor with tahini 🥄, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, yoghurt 🥣, salt 🧂, pepper 🌑, sumac 🌿, and red pepper flakes 🌶️. Pulse until smooth
4. Transfer to a serving dish, drizzle with olive oil 🫒. Serve with pita or fresh vegetables

Notes

Stores in an airtight container in the fridge for up to a week

Cauliflower Velouté

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🌼 1 large cauliflower, cut into florets
- 🥔 2 medium potatoes, peeled and diced
- 🫗 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🧅 1 onion, chopped
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌱 1 litre vegetable broth
- 🌿 1/2 tsp dried thyme
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Heat olive oil 🫗 in a large pot. Sauté onion 🧅 and garlic 🧄 until soft, about 5 min
2. Add cauliflower 🌼, potatoes 🥔, and broth 🌱. Bring to a boil, then simmer 20 min until tender
3. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Stir in thyme 🌿, season with salt and pepper 🧂

Notes

Keeps in the fridge 5 days, freezes up to 3 months

For richer flavour, roast the cauliflower 🌼 before adding to the pot

Serve with crusty bread or a side salad

Gazpacho Andaluz

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍅 1 kg ripe tomatoes, quartered
- 🥒 1 cucumber, peeled and roughly chopped
- 🫑 1 green bell pepper, seeded and chopped
- 🧅 1 small red onion, roughly chopped
- 🧄 1 garlic clove, peeled
- 🍞 50 g stale bread, crusts removed, soaked in a little water
- 🫗 3 tbsp good olive oil
- 🍶 2 tbsp sherry vinegar (or red wine vinegar)
- 💧 150 ml cold water
- 🧂 Salt to taste

Steps

1. Throw everything in a blender — tomatoes 🍅, cucumber 🥒, pepper 🫑, onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, soaked bread 🍞, olive oil 🫗, vinegar 🍶, water 💧, and a good pinch of salt 🧂
2. Blitz until completely smooth, 1–2 minutes
3. Strain through a fine sieve if you want it silky; skip if you like it rustic
4. Taste and adjust: more vinegar 🍶 for brightness, more salt 🧂, maybe a splash more water 💧 if thick
5. Chill at least 2 hours (or overnight). Serve very cold

Garnish ideas

Diced cucumber 🥒, bell pepper 🫑, and red onion 🧅

Hard-boiled egg 🥚, chopped

Croutons 🍞 or a drizzle of olive oil 🫗

Notes

Add half a roasted red pepper for sweetness and depth

A pinch of smoked paprika gives it a subtle warmth

Hummus

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥫 400g can chickpeas, rinsed and drained
- 🍋 2 lemons, juiced
- 🧄 1 garlic clove
- 🧂 1/2 tsp fine sea salt
- 🥄 1/2 cup tahini
- 💧 2 tbsp water
- 🌿 1/2 tsp ground cumin
- 🫒 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil

Steps

1. Place chickpeas 🥫, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, tahini 🥄, salt 🧂, water 💧, cumin 🌿, and olive oil 🫒 in a food processor. Pulse until smooth
2. If too thick, add water 💧 one tablespoon at a time. Adjust seasoning
3. Transfer to a serving dish and drizzle with olive oil 🫒

Notes

Stores in the fridge for up to a week

Garnish with parsley, paprika, or toasted pine nuts

Pumpkin Miso Soup

Servings: 4

Prep: Roasted Pumpkin

🎃 1 medium pumpkin

🫗 2 tbsp olive oil

1. Preheat oven to 200°C. Cut the pumpkin 🎃 in half, scoop out seeds, leave skin on
2. Spread olive oil 🫗 on the pumpkin 🎃 halves, place on a baking sheet
3. Roast 25–30 min until tender and edges are slightly browned
4. Cool 10 min, then scoop out flesh and discard skin

Ingredients

🏺 1 tbsp toasted sesame oil

🧅 1 medium yellow onion, finely chopped

🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced

💛 1 tbsp fresh ginger, grated

🌱 1 litre vegetable broth

🎃 400g pumpkin purée (from prep above)

🥄 3 tbsp white miso paste

🍶 1 tbsp soy sauce

🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

🟢 Sliced green onions or nori strips (optional)

Steps

1. Heat sesame oil 🏺 in a large pot. Sauté onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and ginger 💛 until translucent, about 5 min
2. Stir in pumpkin purée 🎃 and broth 🌱. Bring to a boil, then reduce to a simmer
3. Add soy sauce 🍶 and miso paste 🥄 — do not boil after adding miso
4. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Simmer 20 min
5. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Serve garnished with green onions 🟢

Notes

Stores in the fridge up to a week, freezes well

Substitute butternut squash for pumpkin 🎃

Add a splash of coconut milk for creamier texture

Red Lentil Soup (Instant Pot)

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🔴 1 1/2 cups red lentils, rinsed
- 🧅 1 onion, diced
- 🥕 2 carrots, diced
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 🫒 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🌿 1 tsp cumin + 1 tsp turmeric + 1/2 tsp paprika
- 🍅 1 can (400g) diced tomatoes
- 🌱 4 cups vegetable broth
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Set Instant Pot to sauté. Heat olive oil 🫒, cook onion 🧅, carrots 🥕, and garlic 🧄 for 3 min
2. Add spices 🌿 and stir 30 seconds until fragrant
3. Add lentils 🔴, tomatoes 🍅, and broth 🌱. Stir to combine
4. Seal and pressure cook on high for 10 min. Natural release 10 min
5. Blend with an immersion blender until smooth. Stir in lemon juice 🍋, season with salt and pepper 🧂

Notes

Top with a swirl of olive oil and fresh cilantro

Freezes well for up to 3 months

Shrimp & Corn Chowder

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥓 4 slices bacon, diced
- 🦐 450g medium shrimp, peeled and deveined
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, diced
- 🧅 1 onion, diced
- 🌶️ 2 tsp smoked paprika + 1/2 tsp oregano + 1/2 tsp basil
- 🍗 4 cups chicken stock
- 🌽 2 cups corn kernels
- 🥛 1/4 cup heavy cream
- 🌿 2 tbsp fresh parsley, chopped
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Cook bacon 🥓 in a large pot until crispy. Set aside, keep 1 tbsp fat
2. Sear shrimp 🦐 in the pot until pink, about 2 min. Set aside
3. Sauté garlic 🧄 and onion 🧅 until translucent. Add spices 🌶️, season with salt and pepper 🧂
4. Add chicken stock 🍗 and corn 🌽. Boil, then simmer 15 min until thickened
5. Stir in cream 🥛 and blend with an immersion blender
6. Serve topped with shrimp 🦐, bacon 🥓, and parsley 🌿

Notes

Roasted corn adds extra smoky sweetness

Tzatziki

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥣 1 cup Greek yoghurt
- 🥒 1 cucumber, peeled and grated
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 1 tbsp fresh dill or mint, chopped
- 🫒 1 tbsp olive oil
- 🍋 1 tbsp lemon juice
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Grate the cucumber 🥒, place in a sieve and press out as much liquid as possible. Let drain a few minutes
2. Combine drained cucumber 🥒, yoghurt 🥣, garlic 🧄, olive oil 🫒, lemon juice 🍋, and dill 🌿 in a bowl. Mix well
3. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Adjust garlic 🧄 and herbs 🌿 to taste
4. Refrigerate at least 1 hour before serving

Notes

Drain the cucumber 🥒 thoroughly to avoid watery tzatziki

Stores in the fridge for a few days

Asparagus Risotto

Servings: 4

Ingredients

🌾 300g arborio rice
🟢 500g asparagus, cut into 2cm pieces
🧅 1 shallot, finely diced
🧄 2 cloves garlic, minced
🍷 150ml white wine
🥣 700ml hot chicken stock
🧀 50g parmesan, grated
🧈 20g butter
🫒 1 tbsp olive oil
🧂 Salt & pepper

Steps

1. Set Instant Pot to Sauté, heat olive oil 🫒
2. Cook shallot 🧅 2-3 min until soft, add garlic 🧄 30 sec
3. Add rice 🌾, stir 1-2 min until edges are translucent
4. Pour in wine 🍷, stir until absorbed
5. Add stock 🥣 and asparagus 🟢 — mix well
6. Seal, cook on High Pressure 6 min, quick release
7. Stir in parmesan 🧀 and butter 🧈, rest 2 min, season

Notes

Use it all — stalks and tips together, no waste

Upgrade: char the asparagus tips under the grill before adding at the end

Chicken Tikka Masala

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍗 900g chicken thighs, cut in chunks
- 🍅 1 can crushed tomatoes (400g)
- 🥥 1 can coconut cream
- 🧅 1 onion, diced
- 🧄 4 cloves garlic, minced
- 🫚 2 tbsp garam masala, 1 tbsp cumin, 1 tsp turmeric, 1 tsp chili powder
- 🥣 200ml chicken broth
- 🍚 Rice to serve

Steps

1. Sauté the onion 🧅 in the Instant Pot on Sauté mode, 2-3 min until translucent
2. Add the garlic 🧄 and all spices 🫚, stir 1 min
3. Add the chicken 🍗, tomatoes 🍅, and broth 🥣 — mix everything together
4. Seal the IP, pressure cook 9 min
5. Quick release → stir in the coconut cream 🥥
6. Cook on Sauté 3-5 min to thicken slightly
7. Serve with rice 🍚

Notes

Enhancements: naan bread alongside rice, add cashews or almonds for crunch, finish with fresh cilantro and lemon

Chile Crisp Honey Roasted Salmon

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🐟 900g center-cut salmon fillet (skin on or off)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper
- 🥚 60g mayonnaise
- 🌶️ 2 tbsp chile crisp, plus more to taste
- 🍯 2 tbsp honey
- 🍋 Zest of 1 lemon

Steps

1. Heat oven to 190°C with a rack in the middle
2. Put the salmon 🐟 in a snug baking dish, season both sides with salt and pepper 🧂, and place it skin-side down if using skin-on fish
3. Mix mayonnaise 🥚, chile crisp 🌶️, honey 🍯, and lemon zest 🍋. Taste and adjust with more chile crisp for heat or honey for sweetness
4. Spread the sauce evenly over the salmon 🐟
5. Roast 15–25 min, depending on thickness, until the thickest part flakes easily and the topping bubbles at the edges
6. Spoon any glaze from the dish back over the salmon before serving

Notes

Adapted from Naz Deravian, NYT Cooking

Serve with rice, roasted potatoes, or a peppery arugula salad

Instant Pot Dal

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🔴 500g red lentils, rinsed
- 🧅 2 onions, diced
- 🧄 8 cloves garlic, minced
- 🫚 2 tbsp fresh ginger, grated
- 🍅 2 cans (800ml) diced tomatoes
- 🌿 2 tsp turmeric
- 🌿 2 tsp cumin
- 🌿 2 tsp garam masala
- 🌶️ 1 tsp chili powder
- 💧 1.2L water or broth
- 🧂 2 tsp salt
- 🧈 80g butter or ghee

Steps

1. Sauté mode: melt butter 🧈, add onion 🧅. Cook 3–4 min until soft.
2. Add garlic 🧄, ginger 🫚, all spices 🌿🌶️. Stir 1 min until fragrant.
3. Add lentils 🔴, tomatoes 🍅, water 💧, salt 🧂. Stir, scrape any bits from the bottom.
4. Pressure cook 10 min high, natural release 10 min, then quick release.
5. Stir well — it'll thicken as it cools. Add hot water if too thick.
6. Serve with rice 🍚 or naan. Yogurt on top if you have it.

Notes

Simple weeknight dinner — skip the tadka and bloom the spices right in the pot

Good with a dollop of yogurt and fresh cilantro

Freezes well

Jamaican Chicken

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍗 600g chicken thighs
- 🌶️ 2.5 tbsp Karjos Easispice Chicken Seasoning (or Jamaican jerk spice mix)
- 🫒 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🍋 2 tbsp lime juice
- 🧅 1 onion, sliced (optional)
- 💧 ¼ cup water or broth

Steps

1. Rub chicken thighs 🍗 with spice mix 🌶️
2. Set Instant Pot to Sauté, heat olive oil 🫒
3. Sear thighs 3 min per side until browned, remove
4. Add onion 🧅, sauté 2 min
5. Deglaze with lime juice 🍋, scrape the bottom
6. Add water 💧, return chicken to pot
7. Seal, cook on High Pressure 10 min, natural release 10 min
8. Rest 2 min, slice or serve whole

Lazy Mode

Skip the sear — just rub the chicken with spices and place it in the pot with ¼ cup broth. HP 10 min, natural release 10 min. Done.

Notes

Don't add extra salt — the spice mix is already salted

Optional: finish under the broiler 2–3 min for crispy skin

Serve with coconut rice or cabbage slaw

Japanese Dressed Tuna

Servings: 2

Ingredients

- 🐟 1 can tuna in oil (~150–160 g), drained well
- 🍶 1 tbsp soy sauce
- 🫘 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 🍚 1 tsp rice vinegar (or mirin for a sweeter touch)
- 🌱 1 scallion, thinly sliced (optional)
- 🌶️ Pinch of chili flakes or shichimi togarashi (optional)
- 🍚 Cooked rice, to serve

Steps

1. Drain the tuna 🐟 well and flake it into a bowl
2. Add soy sauce 🍶, sesame oil 🫘, and rice vinegar. Mix gently
3. Fold in scallion 🌱 and chili 🌶️ if using
4. Serve over warm rice 🍚, on toast, or in a salad

Notes

Grated ginger and toasted sesame seeds are great upgrades

A soft-boiled egg on top turns it into a full meal

Also works cold as a rice-bowl topping for lunch boxes

Lomo Saltado (Oyster Sauce)

Servings: 4

Ingredients

Sauce

4 tbsp soy sauce (low sodium)

1 tbsp oyster sauce

1 tbsp red wine vinegar

1 tbsp aji amarillo paste

Stir-fry

🥩 500g sirloin or filet, sliced thin against the grain

🧅 1 red onion, sliced into thick wedges

🍅 2 tomatoes, cut into wedges

🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced

🫗 1–2 tbsp neutral oil (vegetable, canola, avocado)

🥔 2 large potatoes, cut into fries

🌿 Fresh cilantro, chopped

Steps

Heat control: high → medium-high → high

1. **Marinate beef:** toss sliced beef with a splash of soy sauce and half the garlic. Let sit 5–7 min while you prep the rest
2. **Mix sauce:** combine soy sauce, oyster sauce, vinegar, and aji amarillo paste in a small bowl
3. **Cook potatoes:** fry or air-fry until crispy, set aside
4. **Sear beef:** heat oil until shimmering. Sear beef in batches over **high heat**, **1–2 min per side only**. Pull while still pink — it finishes later. Remove and set aside
5. **Onion:** keep **high heat**. Sauté onion 1–2 min until charred at the edges
6. **Garlic + tomatoes:** drop to **medium-high**. Add remaining garlic for 30 sec, then tomatoes for 1 min
7. **Combine:** crank back to **high**, return beef, pour in sauce, toss 30 seconds
8. **Serve:** garnish with cilantro, serve with rice and crispy potatoes on the side

Notes

Skip cornstarch in the sauce for a thinner, restaurant-style finish

Aji amarillo substitutes:

Best: Cholula chili-garlic sauce — 1–2 tsp (good heat + garlic fits the dish)

Alternative: pickled jalapeños — 1–2 tbsp chopped (reduce vinegar slightly)

Not ideal: chili crisp — too oily for this sauce

Hack: 1 tsp Criolla + ½ tsp chili crisp for extra aromatic crunch

The wok must be very hot for proper searing

Lomo Saltado

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥩 500g beef sirloin, cut into strips
- 🧅 1 red onion, sliced into wedges
- 🍅 2 tomatoes, cut into wedges
- 🌶️ 1 ají amarillo (or jalapeño), sliced
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🍶 2 tbsp soy sauce
- 🍇 2 tbsp red wine vinegar
- 🫗 2 tbsp vegetable oil
- 🥔 2 large potatoes, cut into fries
- 🌿 Fresh cilantro, chopped

Steps

1. Fry the potatoes 🥔 until golden and crispy. Set aside
2. Heat oil 🫗 in a wok over high heat. Sear the beef 🥩 in batches until browned. Set aside
3. In the same wok, stir-fry onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and ají amarillo 🌶️ for 1 min
4. Add tomatoes 🍅, soy sauce 🍶, and vinegar 🍇. Toss for 30 seconds
5. Return the beef 🥩, add fries 🥔, and toss together. Garnish with cilantro 🌿

Notes

Serve with steamed white rice

The wok must be very hot for proper searing

Mediterranean Baked White Fish

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🐟 4 white fish fillets (cod, halibut, or sea bass)
- 🫒 2 tbsp olive oil
- 🍋 1 lemon, juiced and zested
- 🧄 4 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 2 tsp dried oregano + 1 tbsp fresh thyme
- 🧅 1 red onion, minced
- 🍅 300g cherry tomatoes, halved
- 🫒 100g pitted olives (kalamata, green, or mix)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 200°C
2. Mix olive oil 🫒, lemon juice 🍋, garlic 🧄, herbs 🌿, salt and pepper 🧂
3. Place fish fillets 🐟 in a baking dish. Pour the herb-lemon mixture over them, coating evenly
4. Scatter cherry tomatoes 🍅, olives 🫒, and red onion 🧅 around and on top of the fish 🐟
5. Bake 15–20 min until the fish 🐟 flakes easily with a fork

Notes

Serve with rice, couscous, or a green salad

Add capers for extra Mediterranean flavour

Merguez Vegetable Tagine

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🌭 450g merguez sausage
- 🧅 2 sweet white onions, sliced
- 🥕 250g carrots, peeled and sliced lengthwise
- 🎃 1 small butternut squash, peeled and chopped
- 🥒 250g zucchini, sliced lengthwise
- 🧄 3 garlic cloves, chopped
- 🫒 1 cup green olives, pitted
- 🍋 1 lemon, quartered
- 🫘 1 cup cooked chickpeas
- 🍇 1/2 cup golden raisins + 1/2 cup dried apricots, chopped
- 🌿 1 cup cilantro, finely chopped
- 🟤 2 tsp cinnamon + 1 tsp coriander + 2 tsp paprika + 1 tsp turmeric + 3 tsp cumin
- 🫗 1/4 cup olive oil
- 🍗 3 cups chicken stock
- 🌾 1 tbsp flour

Steps

1. Heat olive oil 🫗 in a large pot. Add the spice mix 🟤 and stir briefly
2. Add lemon 🍋, onions 🧅, garlic 🧄, and olives 🫒. Cook until soft, about 15 min
3. Brown the merguez 🌭 in a skillet, reserve the rendered oil. Set aside
4. Stir flour 🌾 into the pot, add chicken stock 🍗 and simmer 5 min
5. Add merguez 🌭 with its oil, carrots 🥕, squash 🎃, zucchini 🥒, chickpeas 🫘, raisins and apricots 🍇. Cook 15 min until tender
6. Garnish with cilantro 🌿. Serve with couscous

Notes

Use a tagine if available, otherwise a dutch oven works great

Stir turmeric into the couscous before covering for a yellow hue

Miso-Chile Asparagus With Tofu

Servings: 3

Ingredients

- 🧊 1 block (14–16 oz) firm tofu, drained and cubed
- 🌿 1 lb asparagus, trimmed
- 🪒 3 tbsp neutral oil (grapeseed or peanut)
- 🧂 Salt
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 🌶️ ½ tsp red-pepper flakes, plus more for serving
- 🫘 2 tbsp white miso
- 🍶 1 tbsp sake (or white wine)
- 🍚 1 tbsp rice vinegar
- 🍯 1 tbsp mirin
- 🫙 1 tsp toasted sesame oil
- 🧅 Sliced scallions, for garnish

Steps

1. Heat broiler with rack 6 inches from heat. Cube the tofu 🧊 and pat dry. Toss tofu 🧊 and asparagus 🌿 on a foil-lined sheet pan with 2 tbsp oil 🪒, season with salt 🧂, and spread in one layer
2. Broil until lightly browned, 3–6 min. Flip and broil until asparagus 🌿 is tender and tofu 🧊 is charred in spots, 3–7 min more
3. Meanwhile, heat remaining 1 tbsp oil 🪒 in a skillet over medium. Cook garlic 🧄 and red-pepper flakes 🌶️ until fragrant, 30–60 sec. Remove from heat and whisk in miso 🫘, sake 🍶, vinegar 🍚, mirin 🍯, and sesame oil 🫙
4. Slather miso sauce over asparagus 🌿 and tofu 🧊, return to broiler 30 sec–2 min until bubbling. Garnish with scallions 🧅 and extra red-pepper flakes 🌶️

Notes

Serve over rice or noodles for a complete meal

Easy Pad Thai

Servings: 2

Ingredients

- 🍜 200g flat rice noodles
- 🍤 200g shrimp, peeled
- 🥚 2 eggs
- 🫘 2 tbsp fish sauce
- 🍯 1 tbsp tamarind paste
- 🍚 1 tbsp sugar
- 🧄 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 🥜 30g roasted peanuts, crushed
- 🌱 2 spring onions, sliced
- 🍋 1 lime, cut into wedges

Steps

1. Soak the rice noodles 🍜 in warm water for 20 min, then drain
2. Mix the fish sauce 🫘, tamarind paste 🍯, and sugar 🍚 in a small bowl
3. Stir-fry the garlic 🧄 for 30 seconds, add the shrimp 🍤 and cook until pink
4. Push aside and scramble the eggs 🥚 in the same pan
5. Add the noodles 🍜 and sauce, toss until well coated
6. Serve topped with peanuts 🥜, spring onions 🌱, and lime 🍋 wedges

Notes

Swap shrimp for tofu or chicken if preferred

Add bean sprouts and chili flakes for extra texture and heat

Pesto Beans

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🫒 8 tbsp olive oil
- 🌰 ¼ cup pine nuts or sliced almonds
- 🟡 ½ tsp ground turmeric
- 🧅 3 large shallots, thinly sliced
- 🧄 5 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 🫘 2 (400g) cans cannellini beans, drained
- 🍲 1 cup vegetable or chicken stock
- 🧀 1 cup finely grated Parmesan, plus more for serving
- 🌿 1½ cups tightly packed basil leaves
- 🍋 1 lemon, cut into wedges

Steps

1. Heat 6 tbsp olive oil 🫒 over medium-low. Add the pine nuts 🌰 and stir until golden, ~5 min. Stir in turmeric 🟡, season with salt & pepper, transfer nuts and oil to a bowl.
2. Heat remaining 2 tbsp olive oil 🫒 over medium-high. Add shallots 🧅 with a pinch of salt, cook ~3 min. Stir in garlic 🧄 for 1 min, then add beans 🫘 and stock 🍲. Bring to a simmer, reduce to low.
3. Sprinkle in Parmesan 🧀 in batches, stirring vigorously until creamy. Season with salt, turn off heat. Tear basil 🌿 and stir into the hot beans.
4. Serve drizzled with the sizzled nut oil, a squeeze of lemon 🍋, black pepper and extra Parmesan 🧀.

Shaved Asparagus Pizza

Servings: 1 pizza (12")

Ingredients

🟢 500g asparagus

🧀 ¼ cup grated Parmesan

🧀 225g mozzarella, shredded or cubed

🫒 2 tsp olive oil

🧂 ½ tsp coarse salt

⬛ Black pepper

🌿 2 scallions, thinly sliced

🍕 1 premade pizza dough (thin, 12")

Steps

1. Preheat oven to max (250°C / 500°F). Pizza stone in if you have one.
2. Shave asparagus — hold by the tough end, use a Y-peeler to peel long thin ribbons from base to tip. Discard tough ends.
3. Toss shavings with olive oil, salt, and pepper.
4. Stretch out dough on a floured surface.
5. Top with mozzarella, then pile on asparagus shavings and Parmesan.
6. Scatter scallion on top.
7. Bake 8–10 min until crust is golden and charred at edges.

Notes

Use a mandoline if no Y-peeler — same effect, watch your fingers

Upgrade: drizzle with lemon juice or add prosciutto ribbons before baking

Tomates Farcies

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍅 4 large tomatoes (or 8 small)
- 🥩 500g sausage meat
- 🧅 3 onions, finely chopped
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, minced
- 🌿 Fresh thyme + parsley
- 🧈 Butter (a knob per tomato)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 180°C
2. Mix half the onions 🧅 with sausage meat 🥩, garlic 🧄, parsley 🌿, salt and pepper 🧂
3. Cut tops off tomatoes 🍅, scoop out flesh. Season insides with salt and pepper 🧂. Fill with the meat stuffing 🥩, replace lids
4. Spread remaining onions 🧅 and tomato flesh in a baking dish. Place stuffed tomatoes 🍅 on top
5. Sprinkle with thyme 🌿, add a knob of butter 🧈 on each. Bake 1 hour

Notes

Serve with steamed rice

Chinese Blistered Green Beans

Servings: 4

Ingredients

🫘 400–500g green beans, trimmed and dried well

🫒 2–3 tbsp neutral oil

🧄 2 cloves garlic, finely chopped

🫚 1–2 tsp fresh ginger, minced

🥫 1–2 tbsp soy sauce

🍬 1 tsp sugar

🍶 1–2 tsp Chinese black vinegar (or balsamic)

Steps

1. Dry the beans very well — critical for blistering
2. Heat a wok or large frying pan over high heat, add oil 🫒
3. Add beans 🫘, cook 8–10 min, turning often, until blistered and charred in spots
4. Push beans aside, add garlic 🧄 + ginger 🫚, fry 30 sec
5. Return beans to the pan
6. Add soy sauce 🥫, sugar 🍬, and vinegar 🍶 — toss 1–2 min, serve

Notes

High heat is key — that's what creates the blistered texture

Don't overcrowd the pan, or they'll steam instead of blister

Works great as a side for fish or with rice

Dijon-Braised Brussels Sprouts

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🥬 450g brussels sprouts, trimmed and halved
- 🧈 1 tbsp unsalted butter
- 🫒 1 tbsp olive oil
- 🧅 2–3 shallots, thinly sliced
- 🍷 1/2 cup dry white wine
- 🍗 1 cup chicken or vegetable broth
- 🥛 2 tbsp heavy cream
- 🟡 1 tbsp dijon mustard (or more to taste)
- 🌿 2 tbsp flat-leaf parsley, chopped (optional)
- 🧂 Salt and pepper to taste

Steps

1. Heat butter 🧈 and oil 🫒 in a large skillet over medium heat
2. Place sprouts 🥬 cut-side down in one layer. Cook without turning until golden, about 5 min
3. Add shallots 🧅, wine 🍷, and broth 🍗. Bring to a simmer, cover, cook 15–20 min until tender
4. Remove sprouts 🥬. Add cream 🥛, simmer 2–3 min until thickened. Whisk in mustard 🟡
5. Season with salt and pepper 🧂. Pour sauce over sprouts 🥬, garnish with parsley 🌿

Notes

Brown sprouts in batches if they don't fit in one layer

Gratin Dauphinois

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🥔 1.5kg potatoes
- 🧄 2 cloves garlic, finely chopped
- 🥛 1l milk
- 🫙 30cl cream
- 🧈 100g butter
- 🫚 pinch of nutmeg
- 🧂 salt and pepper

Steps

1. Peel, wash and thinly slice the potatoes 🥔 (don't rinse after slicing — the starch is needed)
2. Bring the milk 🥛, garlic 🧄, salt 🧂 and nutmeg 🫚 to a boil, add the potatoes 🥔 and simmer 10–15 min
3. Preheat oven to 180°C and butter a gratin dish with some of the butter 🧈
4. Transfer the drained potatoes 🥔 to the dish, pour over the cream 🫙 and dot with remaining butter 🧈
5. Bake for 50 min to 1 hour until golden

Notes

Use the leftover milk from step 2 for soup or mashed potatoes

Grilled Eggplant Salad

Servings: 4

Ingredients

- 🍆 1 large eggplant
- 🍅 1 plum tomato, diced
- 🍋 1½ tsp red wine vinegar
- 🧂 ½ tsp kosher salt, more to taste
- 🌿 ½ tsp chopped fresh oregano
- 🧄 2 garlic cloves, finely chopped
- 🫒 3 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 🌿 3 tbsp chopped parsley
- ⚫ Black pepper, to taste
- 🫒 Capers, for garnish (optional)
- 🫓 Grilled pita bread, for serving

Steps

1. Heat grill to medium-high. Prick the eggplant 🍆 all over with a fork and place on the grill. Close the cover and cook, turning occasionally, until very soft and skin is blistered, about 15 minutes
2. When cool enough to handle, scoop out the insides of the eggplant 🍆 and coarsely chop
3. Transfer to a bowl and toss with tomato 🍅, vinegar 🍋, salt 🧂, oregano 🌿, and garlic 🧄
4. Stir in olive oil 🫒 and parsley 🌿. Season with pepper ⚫ and more salt if needed
5. Garnish with capers 🫒 if desired. Serve with warm pita bread 🫓

Notes

Let the grilled eggplant drain in a colander while cooling — the bitter juices escape leaving a milder flavour

For more smoky char, slice into ¾" slabs, brush with olive oil, and grill both sides instead of cooking whole

Lemon juice works well in place of red wine vinegar

Make it a few hours ahead to let the garlic mellow

Rice-Stuffed Tomatoes

Servings: 6

Ingredients

- 🍅 6 medium-large tomatoes
- 🍚 9 tbsp arborio rice
- 🧅 1/4 medium onion, finely chopped
- 🧄 1 garlic clove, minced
- 🌶️ Red pepper flakes to taste
- 🫗 2–3 tbsp olive oil
- 🌿 Few tbsp chopped parsley, oregano, or basil
- 🍞 Handful of breadcrumbs (optional)
- 🧂 Salt to taste

Steps

1. Preheat oven to 175°C. Lightly oil a baking dish
2. Cut tops off tomatoes 🍅, scoop out flesh and juice into a bowl. Salt cavities, drain upside down
3. Pulse the scooped flesh into a coarse purée
4. Heat olive oil 🫗, sauté onion 🧅, garlic 🧄, and pepper flakes 🌶️ for 2 min. Add rice 🍚, toast 3 min
5. Add tomato purée, season with salt 🧂, cover and simmer 10–15 min until rice 🍚 is par-cooked. Stir in herbs 🌿
6. Fill tomatoes 🍅 to 7/8 full. Top with breadcrumbs 🍞 or tomato lids. Bake uncovered 30 min

Notes

Leave room in the tomatoes for rice to finish expanding

Crêpes

Servings: 15

Ingredients

- 🌾 300g flour
- 🥚 3 eggs
- 🥛 75cl milk
- 🛢️ 3 tbsp oil

Steps

1. Mix flour 🌾, eggs 🥚, milk 🥛, and oil 🛢️ until smooth
2. Cook one at a time in a non-stick crêpe pan over medium heat
3. Flip when edges lift and underside is golden, about 1 min per side

Notes

Rub pan with an oiled paper towel if not using non-stick

Fill with sugar & lemon, Nutella, or ham & cheese

Lemon Poppy Seed Muffins

Servings: 12 muffins

Ingredients

- 🌾 2 cups all-purpose flour
- 🍚 1 cup sugar
- 🌽 1/3 cup cornmeal
- 🌱 3 tbsp poppy seeds
- 🥄 2 tsp baking powder and 1/2 tsp salt
- 🥣 1 cup plain Greek yogurt
- 🥚 2 eggs
- 🧈 113g butter, melted and cooled
- 🍋 1/4 cup bottled lemon juice and zest of 1 lime
- 🍯 Glaze: 1/4 cup sugar, 3 tbsp bottled lemon juice, 1 tbsp water

Steps

1. Heat oven to 200°C. Line a 12-cup muffin tin
2. Whisk flour 🌾, sugar 🍚, cornmeal 🌽, poppy seeds 🌱, baking powder, and salt 🥄
3. Whisk Greek yogurt 🥣, eggs 🥚, butter 🧈, lemon juice, and lime zest 🍋
4. Fold wet into dry just until combined. Divide between cups
5. Bake 18–20 min, until a toothpick comes out clean
6. Heat glaze 🍯 until dissolved; brush over the warm muffins

Pancakes

Servings: 8-10 pancakes

Ingredients

- 🌾 1 1/2 cups all-purpose flour
- 🥄 3 1/2 tsp baking powder
- 🍚 1 tbsp white sugar
- 🧂 1/4 tsp salt
- 🥛 1 1/4 cups milk
- 🧈 3 tbsp butter, melted
- 🥚 1 egg

Steps

1. Whisk together flour 🌾, baking powder 🥄, sugar 🍚, and salt 🧂
2. Add milk 🥛, melted butter 🧈, and egg 🥚. Whisk until smooth
3. Heat a lightly oiled pan over medium-high heat
4. Pour about 1/4 cup batter per pancake. Brown 2–3 min on each side. Serve hot

Notes

Add sliced fruit, vanilla extract, or cocoa powder to the batter for variations

Filter Coffee

Servings: 1-3 big mugs

Ingredients

☕ Ground filter coffee

💧 Water

Steps

1. For 1 big mug: use 3 scoops coffee and fill water to the **4–6** line
2. For 2 big mugs: use 6 scoops coffee and fill water to about the **8–12** equivalent
3. For 3 big mugs: use 9 scoops coffee and fill water to about the **12–18** equivalent
4. For a bigger pot for 2–3 people: use **7–8 scoops** and fill around the **12-ish** line
5. For Sam, err weak: start with **7 scoops** rather than 8–9

Notes

Scale linearly from the 1-mug baseline.

If it tastes too thin, increase by 1 scoop next time.